

Writing a blog post

Overview

The purpose of a blog is to share knowledge or experience on specific topics ranging from cooking to travel to technology. Blogs are often a way of sharing personal thoughts and reflections on a topic and so may also be used to share opinions and commentary on a variety of issues.

Another feature of a blog is that they invite or encourage readers to comment on or discuss the content and therefore they are a way of connecting people with similar interests. Blog posts tend to be informal in style and provide opportunities to share personal experience and opinions using conversational language.

Tips for writing a blog

Language – think about:

- **the audience** – this will be people you don't know but who are interested in the topic you are writing about.
- **the tone** – a friendly, conversational style with casual language rather than formal language works best for a blog post.
- **opinions** – blogs are a platform for sharing opinions so include plenty. Using a variety of adjectives will help with this.
- **engagement** – a range of structures, tenses, sentence lengths and interesting vocabulary will catch the attention of your reader.

Organisation – think about:

- **the structure** – although a blog is not a formal text, structuring your blog post is important to help guide the reader through.
 - **Title:** this gives an idea of what the post is about
 - **Introduction:** this puts the post in context and makes it clear why are you writing this post. A short opening sentence works well here or even a question. Some blogs address their readers directly at the start with a casual greeting, such as 'Hello everyone', but this is not essential.
 - **Main body:** this should contain concise paragraphs dealing with the different points you want to make; experiences you are recounting and ideas you are sharing.
 - **Ending:** A final sentence to encourage a response to your post is a good way to round off a blog post
- **linkage** - link your ideas and experiences with connectives to help lead the reader through your post and use adverbs to help make time frames clear.

Example of a blog

	Comments
<i>Lessons learnt from a school exchange</i> 1 <i>Have you ever been on a school exchange trip? I recently returned from one to Germany.</i> 2 <i>The 1000 km coach journey was exhausting, but the speedy German motorways were pretty exhilarating.</i> 3 <i>On arrival in Munich, we had a wonderful warm welcome from our host-families and the next day at school, I had sports lessons and an art workshop. Breaktime table tennis tournaments were a great way to learn German and make new friends.</i> <i>School starts much earlier in Germany, at around 7.30 am, which I found tough, although I can't complain about the 1.30 finish.</i> 4 <i>School exchanges are important because they help us appreciate different cultures, yet we also see that young people everywhere face similar issues.</i> 5 <i>Next year's school trip is to the Alps. What an adventure that will be.</i> 6 <i>What do you think about school exchanges?</i> 7	1 The learner uses a title to catch the attention of potential readers of the blog. 2 Contextualises the topic in this opening paragraph. 3 Uses a wide range of vocabulary and a variety of adjectives to give opinions. 4 Uses well-linked sentences of varying length. 5 The learner uses concise paragraphs to separate ideas and uses a mixture of simple and complex structures. 6 Uses a conversational style, suitable for engaging readers in a blog post. 7 The learner encourages engagement from readers by asking a question at the end.